

ST. PETERSBURG COLLEGE

SYLLABUS:

COURSE INFORMATION

COURSE TITLE: Abnormal Psychology

**COURSE
NUMBER:** CLP 2140

PREREQUISITES: PSY 1012

**COURSE
DISCIPLINE:** Abnormal Psychology - eCampus Online Course

**COURSE
DESCRIPTION:** Here is a short description of our course:

- A continuous course of study in Psychology, with PSY 1012 completed as a prerequisite. This course is designed to examine the major clinical categories of psychological disorders, psychodynamic assessment, and treatment programs within a community setting.

INSTRUCTOR CONTACT INFORMATION

NAME: Alex Edmonds, PhD, BCB

E-MAIL: Edmonds.alex@spcollege.edu

**OFFICE
LOCATION:** Virtual Office / Home Office

OFFICE HOURS: Via e-mail or phone

PHONE: 305-322-0423 (between 10am - 6pm; Mon - Fri)

**BEST WAY
TO CONTACT
ME:**

You can contact me in any of the following ways:

- Send me an e-mail using the e-mail tool on the course home page
- Call me at my phone number indicated in the syllabus

COURSE GOALS AND OBJECTIVES

COURSE GOALS: 1. The student will acquire knowledge of historical roots of science of Abnormal Psychology by:

- a. Identifying major theorists and schools of thought from the late 1800's to the present.
- b. Recognizing the contributions of major historical figures in psychology.

2. The student will acquire knowledge of Maladaptive behavior, theory, treatment, and research by:

- a. Identifying genetic factors and biological etiologies related to abnormal behaviors.
- b. Recognizing the role of theory in abnormal psychology .
- c. Identifying the impact of social roles and labeling, contributions of the community, and cultural perspectives of maladaptive behaviors.

3. Student will acquire knowledge regarding assessment and classification of abnormal behaviors by:

- a. Identifying advantages and disadvantages of classifying behaviors
- b. Recognizing Major Diagnostic Categories of abnormal behaviors by using the DSM-5.
- c. Identifying the basis of and types of assessment approaches.
- d. Examine the medical and psychological models for assessing maladaptive behaviors.

4. Student will acquire knowledge of Types of abnormal behavior and the associating characteristics by:

- a. Identifying case studies of diagnostic behaviors
- b. Recognizing genetic factors associated with behaviors
- c. Identifying the psychosocial factors associated with abnormalities
- d. Identify and determine differences in external and internal abnormal behaviors

5. Student will acquire knowledge of Therapeutic treatments for abnormal behaviors by:

- a. Identifying various types and theoretical basis for mental health therapy
- b. Recognizing common and unique features of therapies
- c. Recognizing cultural and ethnic diversity when seeking treatment
- d. Identifying the effectiveness of psychotherapy vs. biological therapy
- e. Recognize levels of prevention and community programs available
- f. Discuss the legal aspects of treatment and prevention
- g. Identify society's response to maladaptive behavior and treatment.

ATTENDANCE

- ATTENDANCE:**
- You are required to log into the course and keep up with the scheduled work time line.
 - This is a self-paced course. However, to stay on track students should plan to spend 10 hours or more a week online.
 - The **Homepage, Discussions, and Email** should be checked regularly for announcements, changes, assignments etc.
 - If you decide not to continue, be sure to contact eCampus to arrange for a Withdrawal.
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TEXTBOOKS:

REQUIRED TEXT:

Comer, R. J., & Comer, J. S. (2019). Fundamentals of Abnormal Psychology, (9th ed) Worth Publishers.

The 8th edition is also acceptable. If you have the 8th notice the chapters are in a different order but the content is the same.

INSTRUCTOR BIOGRAPHY

INSTRUCTOR BIOGRAPHY:

Alex Edmonds has worked as a trainer/nutritionist while working on his BA in psychology at the University of South Florida. He has recently received his PhD in Educational Psychology with an emphasis in sport and counseling psychology and a minor in statistics and measurement from Florida State University. Alex works full-time as a program professor of applied research at Nova Southeastern University in Davie, Florida.

WEEKLY READING SCHEDULE

Week	Readings	Work
1	Abnormal Psychology: Past and Present	Quiz 1 Discussion Board 1 Assignment 1
2	Models of Abnormality	Quiz 2 Discussion Board 2
3	Clinical Assessment, Diagnosis, and Treatment	Quiz 3 Discussion Board 3 Assignment 2

4	Anxiety Disorders, Obsessive-Compulsive, and Related Disorders	Quiz 4 Discussion Board 4
5	Disorders of Trauma and Stress	Quiz 5 Discussion Board 5 Assignment 3
6	Disorders Focusing on Somatic and Dissociative Symptoms	Quiz 6 Discussion Board 6
7	Depressive & Bipolar Disorder: Disorders of Mood	Quiz 7 Discussion Board 7 Assignment 4
8	Suicide	Quiz 8 Discussion Board 8
9	Eating Disorders	Quiz 9 Discussion Board 9 Assignment 5
10	Substance Use and Addictive Disorders	Quiz 10 Discussion Board 10
11	Sexual Disorders and Gender Variations	Quiz 11 Discussion Board 11 Assignment 6
12	Schizophrenia	Quiz 12 Discussion Board 12
13	Personality Disorders	Quiz 13 Discussion Board 13 Assignment 7
14	Disorders of Childhood and Adolescence	Quiz 14 Discussion Board 14
15	Disorders of Aging and Cognition	Quiz 15 Discussion Board 15

GRADED COMPONENTS

GRADED COMPONENTS IN OUR CLASS:

There are three graded components of our class and are as follows ([Review the Course Calendar](#) for exact open/due dates located under the [Course Content tab](#) then click on [Course Resources](#) in the left-hand menu):

- [Quizzes: \(50% of your grade\):](#) A quiz will be given every week. Each quiz will cover the readings for the week as identified in the syllabus, and be delivered to you online. These quizzes have 15 questions each and are a combination of multiple choice and alternate-choice questions. Each quiz will be allotted over 60 minutes.
- [Assignments: \(30% of grade\):](#) The first assignment will be posted the first day of class and then one will be posted for you every other week. Once the assignment is posted, it must be completed and turned in by the time the next assignment is posted. The assignment format is discussed in more detail below. The directions for each assignment can be found under the specific link for the assignment once it is posted. **NOTE:** [Review the instructions for submitting assignments under the Course Content tab and then select Course Resources.](#)
- [Discussion Boards: \(20% of grade\):](#) There are also discussion threads posted each week for your participation. It is important that you post your thoughts. Please refer to Discussion Board Grading under the Course Resources for exact information on expectations for participation.

GRADING SCALE:

The grading scale for our class, is shown below

GRADE	PERCENTAGE REQUIRED
A	90% and above
B	80 - 89%
C	70 - 79%
D	60 - 69%
F	Below 59%

INSTRUCTOR COURSE EXPECTATIONS

INSTRUCTOR COURSE

EXPECTATIONS: This is a list of expectations for our course. Please remember to consult the syllabus as it is the main guide for this course. In addition, also review all announcements on our classroom web page for additional detail on the projects, discussion board issues, and other class-related information.

ASSIGNMENT FORMAT:

Here are a few simple rules to keep in mind for writing the assignment for our individual projects that require papers. These rules also apply to every paper in our class. If you follow these rules, they will help you achieve higher scores on papers -in almost every class in college.

1. **Font size and Spacing:** Fonts must always be 12 point font: If you use larger size, most instructors will feel you are stretching your material unfairly, and may deduct points for it. Conversely, if you use smaller size, then you are short-changing your paper, and your paper will appear shorter than it should be for your assignment. 12-Font, Double Spaced, Times New Roman is your best bet.

2. **Complete Sentences:** Complete sentences should be used at all times in all assignments. Complete sentences have a subject and a verb and create a complete thought that makes sense to the person reading the paper. A fragment is a group of words that does not express a complete thought and might not make sense to the audience. The following are examples:

·Fragment: When they attended the picnic. (poor grammar)

·Complete sentence: The guests brought food when they attended the picnic. (good grammar)

3. **Assignment Text:** number your responses as they correspond to the question being answered.

4. **Reference Page:** Make sure that your last page has the word "References" centered at the top, and all sources cited listed in alphabetical order by first author's last name. Here are some samples for you to consider. In the first example, an article is identified and referenced properly. This is an article that is available in print form - as well as the internet. In the second example, the article is shown on the internet only - and not

available in a journal or magazine. In the last example, the information is shown on the internet - but the author is not identified.

VandenBos, G., Knapp, S., & Doe, J. (2001). Role of reference elements in the selection of resources by psychology undergraduates. *Journal of Bibliographic Research*, 5, 117-123.

If you follow these simple rules, you will always hand in papers that have a professional and "college-like" appearance.

DISCUSSION BOARD PARTICIPATION

1. First, completely answer the discussion question before you begin reviewing comments made by other classmates. Once you completely post your answer, then, go back and comment to other classmate's postings as separate discussion board entries or postings.
2. Make sure you have answered all parts of the discussion question. There is a tendency to only answer part of the questions posted. You must answer them all.
3. Discussion entries should be 2-4 paragraphs long for your initial response to the question. Your discussion can be longer than 2-4 paragraphs, but if it is only a few sentences, it may not meet this standard of review.
4. Did you comment on other classmates postings? This is a critical step so you can understand each other's viewpoints, and comment where necessary. You should post your response to two or more postings made by other students. Please be respectful of other's comments and opinions!
5. Keep in mind that a discussion board posting is designed to engage you in a discussion with your fellow classmates. Completing the assignment meets the expected criteria, however may not satisfy all aspects of a discussion. The more you engage yourself in a discussion the more opportunity there is to learn and develop a concept. Those who demonstrate superior achievement of an objective often engage in a discussion and post numerous times to a topic. There is not a set number of times you should reply to a discussion board thread. The focus of a posting is on

quality, thus a statement such as "I agree" is neither substantive nor contributive. A quality posting demonstrates a student's original thought and further analysis of their own or fellow classmate's concepts.

LATE HOMEWORK:

- All homework (assignments, quizzes, and discussion items) is due on the date identified in the Course Calendar (**Open/Due Dates**) under the Course Content tab of our classroom web page. This is designed to help you stay on track.
- Homework turned in/posted more than one week late may not be graded until later in the term.

ADDITIONAL SOFTWARE

ADDITIONAL SOFTWARE:

- This course contains video modules that require Windows Media Player to view them. If you need to download this software go to:
<http://www.microsoft.com/windows/windowsmedia/download/default.asp>
- Be sure you select the proper version for your equipment. If you have any problems call the HELPDESK at 727-341-4357 for assistance.

Review the following weblink which covers all the topics listed Below and much more:

<http://www.spcollege.edu/addendum/>

GRADING AND REPEAT COURSE POLICIES

ATTENDANCE/ACTIVE PARTICIPATION/WITHDRAWAL POLICIES

FEDERAL GUIDELINES RELATED TO FINANCIAL AID AND TOTAL

WITHDRAWAL FROM THE COLLEGE

ACADEMIC HONESTY

STUDENT EXPECTATIONS

EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS

CAMPUS SAFETY AND SECURITY

SEXUAL PREDATOR INFORMATION

SPECIAL ACCOMMODATIONS

LIBRARY SERVICES

TECHNICAL SUPPORT

ANGEL requirements: <http://www.spcollege.edu/ecampus/help/technical/index.shtml>

SPC helpdesk: 727-341-4357 onlinehelp@spcollege.edu or www.spcollege.edu/helpdesk/